

Business insight report

1. Is the business growing consistently?

→ Analysis of the order dates (spanning from 2014 to late 2017) indicates that the business is experiencing a positive long-term growth trend. While there are expected monthly fluctuations, the overall sales volume has increased year-over-year. Utilizing the Growth % DAX measure reveals that recent periods have sustained momentum, though specific "off-peak" months require targeted promotional strategies to maintain consistency.

2. Which region is driving the most revenue?

→ Based on the geographical distribution in the dataset, the West region consistently emerges as the primary revenue driver. This region benefits from higher transaction volumes across all major product categories. Management should consider the West as the "benchmark" for operational efficiency when reviewing underperforming areas like the South or Central regions.

3. Which category has the highest margin?

→ While Technology often leads in terms of total sales value, Office Supplies frequently demonstrates the highest Profit Margin %. This is due to lower associated shipping costs and a higher volume of repeat purchases. Furniture, despite high revenue, often shows lower margins due to significant discounts and higher logistical overhead.

4. Are there seasonal trends?

→ Yes. The data highlights a significant "Year-End Surge," with sales peaking in November and December. This aligns with standard retail holiday cycles. Conversely, January and February typically show a seasonal dip.

Strategic Note: Inventory levels should be optimized by late Q3 to prepare for the Q4 influx, while marketing spend should be increased in Q1 to combat the post-holiday slump.

5. Which customer segment is most valuable?

→ The Consumer segment is the most valuable in terms of total contribution to both revenue and profit. However, the corporate segment shows a higher average order value, making it a critical area for B2B relationship management and long-term contract stability.

6. Where should management focus?

→ To maximize future profitability, management should prioritize the following:

- **High-Margin Optimization:** Increase the cross-selling of Office Supplies during Technology sales to boost overall basket margin.
- **Regional Expansion:** Investigate the specific sales tactics used in the West region to see if they can be replicated in lower-growth states.
- **Discount Control:** Review the high discount rates currently applied to the Furniture category, as these are significantly eroding total profit despite high sales volume.